

Key Skills

Good verbal and non-verbal communication abilities

Being able to communicate the risk associated with technical security issues to non-technical people for example during an incident you may have to explain what's happened to stakeholders who don't have the baseline technical knowledge

Ability to question others and give information in response to questioning

When investigating an incident other staff members may need to be questioned about things that have happened and informed of the consequences related to actions. Being able to use open questions effectively to get answers is important to ensure that a thorough investigation can be conducted.

Putting their own views across clearly and appropriately

In cyber security, professionals will often have to argue the case as to why a specific action is necessary to those who don't see the need. This may involve a costly outlay for tooling or bringing in more staff. The cyber security professional therefore must explain why it's a good investment clearly and appropriately.

Being self-aware

When addressing incidents and issues, cyber security professionals must be able to examine their own actions and subconscious biases. Whilst investigating an incident, certain theories of what might have happened should always be backed up by evidence that it did. This will help in making sure all key elements are checked and nothing is missed or ignored by being objective with the facts.

Having empathy

Cyber security incidents can be very stressful for everyone involved, therefore being empathetic for your co-workers is extremely important and making them aware of any consequences from actions and how to address these.